Your Father's Open Care Issues on One Page

Who holds each one, who to contact, and which ones have no one yet.

The notes from the last family call are in three different phones, and nobody is sure who said they'd call the doctor's office.

This page doesn't ask you to solve any of it. It asks what is open, where the notes about it are, who is holding it, and who there is to contact.

The open issues

One line for each issue, in a few plain words. If nobody is holding it, leave that box empty.

OPEN ISSUE	WHO IS HOLDING IT	WHO TO CONTACT	LAST TALKED ABOUT
Tuesday's missed appointment hasn't been rescheduled		The doctor's office	Sunday's call

Where the family's notes are

WHAT TO COLLECT	WHERE IT IS	ITS DATE	WHO HAS IT
Notes from the last family call			
The concerns people have raised, in their own words			
Your father's own account of how things are going			
The list of what has to happen for him each week, and who does each thing			
What your sister, who does most of it, said can't continue as it is			
Accounts of the same event that differ, written side by side			
Questions set aside for the doctor's office, the nurse, the pharmacist or your care consultant			

WHAT TO COLLECT	WHERE IT IS	ITS DATE	WHO HAS IT
Phone numbers for the people the family may need to contact			

What has no one yet

Every open issue with an empty “who is holding it” box, and anything in the second list that nobody can find. Put a name beside each one only when that person has said yes.

FOR EXAMPLE Rescheduling the appointment: nobody has said they'll call. My brother has the notes from Sunday but hasn't sent them around.

How to use it

- Don't retell an issue or explain it here. Name it, and say where the notes are.
- An empty box shows where a gap is. It isn't a comment on anyone.
- Write the date beside each note. If a note has no date, write “undated.”
- Keep the page where everyone in the family can see it, and bring it to the next call.

What this page doesn't do

It doesn't say what any note, record or instruction means, which issue matters most, or who should have been holding it. It shows where things are and where nobody is yet.

Ready for the next step?

You know where every open issue sits, who is holding it, and which ones have no one yet. The care interview uses what you've collected: it goes through your father's situation area by area and turns your answers into a Family Care Profile you can bring to any care conversation.

Create Your Free Family Care Profile ›

WHERE THIS COMES FROM

Keeping shared notes where everyone involved can reach them follows the National Institute on Aging's advice on sharing caregiving responsibilities. The rows come from the Family Care Roadmap's working list for this step.

1. National Institute on Aging, Sharing Caregiving Responsibilities